compromise would be bad as such, and, moreover, could deflate the opposition.

Information has been released regarding the security issue: the suspected terrorist who hid a bomb near the Meggido crossroads, in Galilee (a bomb that seriously wounded a motorist) entered the country from Lebanon and was shot before he managed to slip back. This indicates that Hezbollah, aware of the growing rift within Israeli society and possibly in coordination with Hamas, plans to incite trouble, in the context of heightened terror activities in the West Bank, probably also in view of Ramadan, which starts on March 22. The Shiite group, a proxy for Iran, has tens of thousands of missiles aiming at Israel's major cities and other strategic targets.

Herzog came up with a very reasonable and acceptable compromise: the coalition would not have a majority in the parliamentary committee that appoints Supreme Court justices; for voting Basic Laws, the Knesset would need eighty members and four readings; to cancel Basic Laws, the Supreme Court would need two-thirds of the justices from a total of eleven members. These are some of the proposals. The coalition immediately rejected Herzog's compromise. The opposition fully accepted it. I hope that Herzog will choose the only dignified and courageous next step: resignation.

According to several news outlets, Netanyahu apparently agreed to negotiations on the basis of Herzog's compromise, but is supposed to have told him: "Convince Levin." Either he knew or guessed that Levin would reject the proposal and wished to keep up the image of the wise statesman, able to rise above partisan squabbles, or else he—the man who brought all of this about—is a hostage of the extremists in his coalition, from the Likud and, of course, from beyond.

Thursday, March 16